



● CARDIOLOGY · OBSERVATIONAL PILOT

The Pritikin Cardiac Rehab pilot: patients who opened their orbit started rehab at *more than twice the rate*

Over nine months at a leading Midwest health system, 187 patients referred to Pritikin Intensive Cardiac Rehabilitation (ICR) were invited to a cardiac rehab orbit. Of those who activated it, 52% went on to start the program. Of those who never activated, 24% did. Cohorts as reported by Pritikin ICR, December 2023.

THE FINDING · ACTIVATION PREDICTED ENROLLMENT

52%

ACTIVATED, THEN
STARTED

26 of the 50 patients who activated their orbit started ICR.

24%

NEVER ACTIVATED,
STARTED

34 of the 141 who did not activate. Less than half the activated rate.

32%

COMBINED, ALL
INVITED

Overall start rate across all 187 invited patients.

9

MONTHS OF PILOT
DATA

Pilot months 1 through 9 at one outlet, reported December 2023.

THE TWO COHORTS

Same invitation, different journeys

ACTIVATED THEIR ORBIT

52% of this cohort started ICR

187	50	26	1,302
invited to an orbit	activated their orbit	started ICR	ICR sessions completed

DID NOT ACTIVATE

24% of this cohort started ICR

187	141	34	1,402
invited to an orbit	did not activate	started ICR	ICR sessions completed

This was an observational pilot, not a randomized trial: patients chose whether to activate, so activation and program start may share underlying causes such as motivation or staff contact. The pilot's own recommendation is a randomized design next.

Three KPIs were set before the pilot began. Two could not be evaluated, and one fell short of its target. All three are reported here.

Growth in new Pritikin ICR enrollments

Target: 10 % year-over-year increase

INCONCLUSIVE

26 enrollments in the pilot period, with no prior-year figures at this site to compare against.

Share of eligible patients invited to an orbit

Target: 90 % of eligible patients

INCONCLUSIVE

187 patients were invited, but the site could not report how many were eligible overall.

Share of invited patients who activate

Target: 75 % activation

BELOW TARGET

27 % activated. Only 27 % of new ICR candidates received the extended engagement emails, treated as the primary cause.

WHAT WE LEARNED**Obstacles, and what changed**

01 No historical ICR start data at the site, so year-over-year comparison was impossible.

Run the next pilot as a true randomized A/B test: every other eligible patient receives an orbit.

02 Year-to-year changes in insurer ICR reimbursement policy and coverage skewed any year-over-year read.

Same fix: a randomized concurrent design removes payer-policy drift from the comparison.

03 Staffing shortages made orbit invitation and onboarding inconsistent; only 27 % of candidates received the engagement pathway emails.

Shorter pilot window plus Epic integration, so invitation and engagement fire automatically rather than depending on staff availability.

04 Orbit activation reached 27 % against a 75 % goal.

Rebuilt engagement pathway emails aimed at a 50 to 75 % activation range.

05 Site staff could not see or manage the status of patients they had invited.

Shipped: patient invitation status is now visible and editable by site staff in the platform.

WHERE IT GOES NEXT

Recommended on the strength of the result: a soft launch across five to ten additional locations with the pilot's weak points fixed first — Epic integration for consistent invitation and outreach, a custom admin dashboard combining EHR, orbit, and Pritikin data, rebuilt engagement pathways to lift activation, and updated contract terms moving from pilot to production. And if the evidence isn't enough yet: a genuine randomized A/B pilot at two new locations.